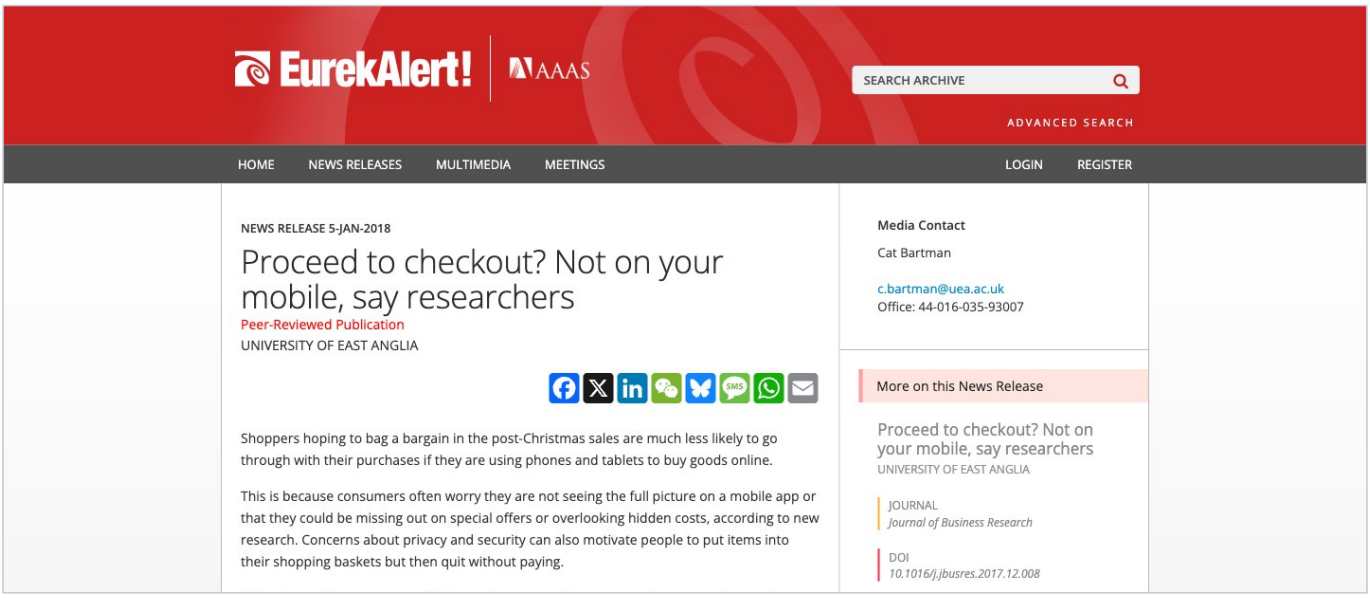
EurekAlert! (University of East Anglia press release)

«Proceed to checkout? Not on your mobile, say researchers»

5 January 2018 · English · University of East Anglia release. Quoted by name.

https://www.eurekalert.org/news-releases/745283

Research. Huang, G.H., Korfiatis, N. and Chang, C.T. (2018). Mobile Shopping Cart Abandonment: The roles of Conflicts, Ambivalence, and Hesitation. *Journal of Business Research*, 85, 165-174.



Researchers at the University of East Anglia (UEA) investigating why this is so say it represents a huge challenge for online retailers, who are investing heavily in mobile shopping, but not reaping the rewards in successful sales.

"Our study results revealed a paradox," said Dr Nikolaos Korfiatis, of Norwich Business School at UEA. "Mobile shopping is supposed to make the process easier, and yet concerns about making the right choice, or about whether the site is secure enough leads to an 'emotional ambivalence' about the transaction - and that mean customers are much more likely to simply abandon their shopping carts without completing a purchase."

The researchers studied online shopping data from 2016-2017 from consumers in Taiwan and the US. They found that the reasons for hesitation at the checkout stage were broadly the same in both countries. In addition, shoppers are much more likely use mobile apps as a way of researching and organising goods, rather than as a purchasing tool, and this also contributes to checkout hesitation.

"People think differently when they use their mobile phones to make purchases," said Dr Korfiatis. "The smaller screen size and uncertainty about missing important details about the purchase make you much more ambivalent about completing the transaction than when you are looking at a big screen."